

M06 RESTORATIVE OPPORTUNITIES | O (MAX : 2 PT)

Intent : Support employee well-being by providing opportunities for recovery and restoration within and outside the workplace.

Summary :

This WELL feature requires projects to support recovery and restoration from work and to encourage a healthy work-life balance by providing opportunities for sleep, breaks throughout the workday and sufficient paid time off.

Issue : Long working hours and insufficient opportunities for recovery are associated with numerous adverse outcomes, including cardiovascular and immunologic reactions, reduced sleep quality and duration and increased risk for stress, burnout, excessive alcohol use and poor diet.^{1,2} Insufficient sleep, in particular, is associated with numerous negative outcomes, such as increased pain and anxiety, impaired performance and productivity and increased errors and risk of accidents.³⁻⁵ Long hours are also connected to reductions in employee creativity and morale.^{2,6} Research shows that working over weekends inhibits recovery from work-related stress and that ongoing periods without vacation have adverse health effects, including increased cardiovascular risk.⁵

Solutions : Employees need sufficient opportunities to psychologically detach and recover during non-work hours, such as weekends, vacations and evenings. ⁵ Findings indicate that mentally distancing oneself from work and engaging in restorative activities on a day-to-day basis is linked to employee well-being, including higher life satisfaction and mood, maintained workplace performance, lower burnout and fewer health complaints.⁵ Targeted interventions, such as limits on working hours and schedule, can help support individuals in achieving sufficient and high-quality sleep.^{7,8} Research indicates that regular vacations may have a protective effect against chronic work stress by providing a sustained period of relief from daily stressors, demands and routines.^{9,10} Short afternoon naps also provide an opportunity for restoration during the workday, leading to benefits in mood, alertness and cognitive performance, such as productivity and learning.^{11,12}

PART 1 SUPPORT HEALTHY WORKING HOURS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

The project or organization has a policy on schedules and time off that meets the following requirements:

- a. For all employees:
 1. A minimum of 11 consecutive hours off from work is available per 24-hour period.^{13,14}
 2. A minimum of 24 consecutive hours off from work is available per 7-day period.¹⁴
 3. Employees who engage in shift work are provided a minimum 48-hour advance notice of shift changes.
- b. For all eligible employees:
 1. A minimum of 20 days of paid time off per calendar year (not including paid sick days or public holidays).¹⁴
 2. Work and work-related communications are not required during paid time off.⁵
 3. Sick, vacation, floating holiday, personal and all other employer-provided days off from work are clearly defined.
 4. Accrual policy is defined, including whether rollover days are allowed and date by which rollover days must be used.
- c. For students in secondary schools (if applicable), the school day starts no earlier than 8:30 a.m.¹⁷

PART 2 PROVIDE NAP POLICY AND SPACE (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

1: Nap policy

The following requirement is met for all eligible employees:

- a. Employees are allowed to engage in at least one nap or rest break of at least 30 minutes during the workday (not to be combined with designated time for meal breaks).^{13,18}

2: Nap space

The following requirements are met for all eligible employees:

- a.
 - Access to at least one acoustically and visually separated environment located in a designated quiet zone.
- b. At least one fully reclining furniture option (e.g., bed, daybed, couch, chair, cushioned roll-out mat, nap pod) for every 100 eligible employees.^{13,18}

Note :

Projects should refer to feature S01 Sound Mapping, Part 1: Label Acoustical Zones for all designated quiet zones.

Projects can utilize one room as a combined nap space (M06) and restorative space (M07). Projects will only receive points for both features, if all requirements for M06 Part 2 and M07 Part 1 have been met.

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